

COMS3011A Project Brief

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1 Overview

1.1 Projects & Groups

Each project is broken down into three tiers: Basic, Intermediate, Advanced. To achieve the basic tier, your project needs to meet all the listed key and basic requirements, as well as achieve the standard of a *minimum viable product*. The intermediate tier needs to meet all the listed basic requirements and the intermediate requirements. The expected standard is that of a functional and useful product. The advanced tier needs to meet *all* listed requirements, even those potentially introduced part way through the semester. The standard of an advanced project is one that can be released to market the day of submission.

You can find a brief problem statement for each project in this document, but additional information will be provided through project specific briefs.

Groups are 4 - 6 members. Please select your group carefully as you may not change your group once the semester has started.

Your group will be assigned a tutor as a 'client'. Their role is to help guide you on the development process and make decisions around if a feature is 'complete' or not. Your tutor will act as the first point of contact for any questions about your project, but the lecturer will be available if you would like further clarification. You will *not* be marked by your client, but by other tutors. The client is however expected to provide some context to the marking tutor on your interactions with them.

1.2 Milestones & Reports

1.2.1 Milestone 1: Sprint 1

Milestone 1 is aimed at project setup and the basics of a project. Setting up the project repositories, getting the largest 'blockers' out of the way, making sure you and your group have a strong direction for the rest of the semester.

1.2.2 Milestone 2: Sprint 2

Milestone 2 is the midpoint of the project, where by the end of this sprint you have a strong base for the project. The most important features are implemented, even if there are issues, and the project is moving towards a stable product through testing and reviews.

1.2.3 Milestone 3: Sprint 3

Milestone 3 is aimed at getting the project into a near-complete state. Most features should be implemented, and mostly working. The project should have gone through reviews and you should be evaluating the state of the project from a qualitative perspective.

1.2.4 Milestone 4: Submission

Milestone 4 is the final submission. Your project should work, work well, and do what it needs to.

The marking of milestone 4 is evaluating your entire project holistically. Over the entire dev-cycle of the project, has your group been consistent with your methodology, how has your projects requirements and plans evolved.

1.2.5 Report 1: Group Report

The group report is a summary of the project's development and a reflection as a group of the entire project. What decisions were made through out the project, why did they occur and what can be done to improve upon them in the future.

The report should be presented as a technical document with references, an introduction, body, conclusion and appendices.

1.2.6 Report 2: Individual Report

The individual report is a reflection of your growth and development throughout the project. What challenges did you encounter, what new technology did you learn about, how did you work as a team, and most importantly, something you are proud of.

The report is an opinionated piece, but should still be presented as academic writing. It should have an introduction, body, conclusion, appendices and use references and evidence based motivation.

1.2.7 Report 3: Peer Review

The peer review is split into two sections:

1. An anonymous review of your group members
2. A personal evaluation of your performance

Your mark is calculated by taking your personal rating and the average rating of your group members.

The peer review will act as a multiplier of your group marks. If you achieve a peer review mark of greater or equal to 50%, you will receive all your group marks. If you achieve a mark less than 50%, you will receive a mark multiplied by a specified value for every group component of the project.

Mark Range	Group Component Multiplier
[50%, 100%]	$\times 1$
[40%, 50%)	$\times 0.8$
[25%, 40%)	$\times 0.6$
[15%, 25%)	$\times 0.4$
[0%, 15%)	$\times 0.2$

1.2.8 Report 4: Group Presentation

The presentation is to demonstrate you understand your project at a technical level, and to 'pitch' it. You must be able to talk about your project, the decisions you made, what makes it cool, and why is it good. The presentation is a great opportunity to bring attention to specific features that might otherwise be overlooked.

You will present your product to a panel of judges, and must cover the following information:

- an overview of your product
- feature demonstrations
- UI and UX showcase

- The product's architecture and features at a high level (no code)

1.3 Timeline

The timeline of your project is over the entire semester. The below dates are preliminary and may be adjusted over the semester.

Event	End Date	Days from Previous
Group Selection	2026-07-26	
Student Project Proposal	2026-07-31	5
Project Assignment	2026-08-02	2
Milestone 1: Sprint 1	2026-08-25	23
Milestone 2: Sprint 2	2026-09-15	21
Milestone 3: Sprint 3	2026-09-29	14
Milestone 4: Submission	2026-10-11	12
Report 1: Group Report	2026-10-18	7
Report 4: Group Presentation	2026-10-19 → 2026-10-23	5
Report 2: Individual Report	2026-10-27	4
Report 3: Peer Review	2026-10-27	0

There are 70 days of dedicated development time for the project.

The back half of this semester will coincide with the CGV project. Please make sure that you have adequately prepared for the reduction in your available development time.

1.4 Artificial Intelligence

For the duration of this project, you are very encouraged to use AI tooling. To encourage transparency and ethical usage, you must attribute your usage of AI.

For complete details of how to attribute AI, please review the dedicated AI policy document, but as a brief summary, you must specify what tool (Claude Code, ChatGPT Web), what model (GPT-5.5, Claude Opus 4.8) and purpose (code, editing).

You are responsible for everything generated and used by AI during this project. Any hallucinations and incorrect artifacts *will* impact your marks. You should be aware that usage of AI may impact the subjective components of marking as it may insufficiently demonstrate or answer the question with the required depth.

2 Projects

2.1 Key Requirements of All projects

Every project needs to implement following requirements.

- Version Control: You are expected to be using some form of git-compliant version control software
- Responsiveness and Accessibility: Your project should conform with modern standards of web applications when it comes to their responsiveness and accessibility.
- CI / CD: Your project should make use of CI/CD processes for both the collaboration and deployment of the application
- A non-monolithic front-end and back-end application
 - If a framework provides a way to implement your front-end and back-end code together, you may use it for either front-end or back-end, not both.
 - Some examples: [Sveltekit](#), [Next.js](#)
 - If you are in doubt, reach out to the lecturer and ask.
- Hand-Written API
 - You must design and implement your API
 - You may not use a system that generates API endpoints
 - Unless you write the generation as part of your project
 - examples: [Firebase](#), [Supabase](#)
 - If in doubt, you should be making requests through an HTTP endpoint
 - If you are unsure about a technology, speak to the lecturer for clarification.
- Authentication & Security
 - Users must be able to sign up, sign in, reset their passwords, and delete their accounts
 - You may not write your own authentication system, instead you must rely on established practices and libraries.
- Integration
 - You must integrate with a *relevant* external API service in some manner.
 - For example: A hiking app checks the weather of the hike's location
- Documentation Website
 - Your project must have a publicly available website that has your documentation
 - Avoid platforms that require an account such as Notion.
 - As a suggestion, use a pre-established docs tool built on top of markdown
 - [Docusaurus](#), [MkDocs](#), [mdBook](#)
 - Deploy this site via static web-hosting
 - [Github Pages](#), [Cloudflare Pages](#)

2.2 Project 1: Tutor Management System

The school of Computer Science and Applied Mathematics is trying to come up with a better way to manage their tutors. They need a platform that allows an organiser to assign the various available tutors to different courses based on a few criteria: The tutor's marks in the course, their availability with their own timetable, and hours per week. This platform also needs to provide a way for students to volunteer

for any overflow work, sign and submit their timesheets, excuse themselves and more admin capabilities.

2.3 Project 2: Sport Coaching Tool

A local coach for (insert favourite sport here) has recently complained that they don't have any good tools to help them manage their sport. They want to be able to use one tool that allows them to track events, player statistics, compare with other teams, track any history and so on. They should be able to organise and plan events with other users of the platform, and have assistants (or themselves) track event history (results, penalties etc.)

2.4 Project 3: Sport Analytics Tool

Large leagues often have databases to help track an athlete's performance. Unsatisfied with (insert favourite sport here)'s current offerings, you have decided to build one of your own for a professional league. This platform needs to allow approved users to submit and manage the statistics for players (or teams), and provide an API for other platforms to use. All statistics that are important for (sport) should be available, and preferably calculated from event data instead of manual entry. This platform should serve as a home for anyone who wants to get into big-data analysis of the sport and should offer API's and datasets to help this process.

2.5 Project 4: Automata Editor and Visualiser

Your FLA lecturer has approached with an idea to help students learn Turing Machines. They would like to build an editor and visualiser for Turing Machines that allows students to edit and save the various machines. The editor needs to be a visual editor of the state diagram, and a code editor for the instructions. The visualiser needs to show and highlight the current configuration of the machine for a specified input and track useful information about the computation.

2.6 Project 5: Olympiad Portal

An organiser for a local olympiad wants to build a portal for competing schools and educators to register and upload results on. The portal should allow educators to download tests and past papers, submit results and have them automarked if it is a multiple choice questionnaire. They would prefer if the portal also provides a way for students to take the test online if possible, but the offline tests should always be available.

2.7 Project 6: Campus Game - Wit's Quest

Inspired by Pokemon Go and tired of the current tours, a lecturer wants to build a web game that gets students (and anyone else) to explore campus. When a player is close to an event, they can participate in a game based off alumni, history, landmarks and any other trivia about the university. If a player is correct or wins the game, they are awarded collectible cards with attributes and properties that can be used in a turn based poke-battle-esque minigame with other players or CPUs.

2.8 Project 7: Digital Logbook

A uni student would like a system that can help them keep track of their projects, what work they've done and what they still need to do. They've been relying on a physical logbook to help them achieve this, but they always forget it at home. To fix this, they've asked you to help build a digital logbook that they can customise the format of, and then quickly capture entries for. This logbook needs to give them useful statistics about what they are doing, how much time they've spent on specific projects. Most importantly however, it needs to give them a record of what they do.

2.9 Student Project

If you have your own idea, you may submit a proposal document that gives us an outline of the project. This document needs to have the following:

- A problem statement - what issue is this project going to solve
- An explanation of how the project meets all the key requirements
- A detailed feature list that categorises features into the three tiers: basic, intermediate and advanced
- Group motivation of why you want to build this project over any of the listed projects
- Significant planning of how you are going to implement the most important features

If you submit your own project, there are a few things you **must** agree to:

- The lecturer reserves the right to reject your proposal where you must then choose one of the listed projects
- Every group gets only one proposal, if it is rejected, you may not submit another
 - You may appeal this decision during a lab where we can discuss in more detail
- You will be held to the standard of your initial proposal
 - Ambition is good, but if you are overly ambitious in the proposal and then fail to reach it, you will be penalised
 - A proposal that does not meet the minimum required standards of the course will be rejected
- A tutor will still be assigned as a 'client' with a slightly modified role
 - The tutor will not make final decisions on which features are in the project
 - The tutor will help build a sustainable development timeline for the project, even if that means they suggest you cut specific features
 - The tutor is there to help you meet the basic requirements you outline in your project proposal

3 Rubrics

3.1 Milestone 1: Sprint 1

Criteria	Weight	Advanced: 80% - 100%	Intermediate: 50% - 80%	Basic: 0% - 50%
Version Control	10%	Exists - code quality tools, commit	Exists - organised file structure &	Exists - no repo → basic organisation

Criteria	Weight	Advanced: 80% - 100%	Intermediate: 50% - 80%	Basic: 0% - 50%
		structure Used - All members have committed code	readme, Used - Most members have committed code	Used - Some members have committed code
Documentation Site	10%	Well-designed, has non-trivial content	Has trivial content	No documentation, Local documentation, online but inaccessible, version controlled
Getting Started / Dev Guides	5%	All repo's feature a README and getting started	Some to Most repo's have a README	No to Some repo's have a README
Work Tracker	5%	Exists & Used	Exists	Does not exist
Git Methodology	5%	Used	Documented	No methodology → insufficient methodology
Project Methodology	10%	Used methodology with evidence, methodology is motivated	Methodology is documented and referenced	No methodology, invented methodology, listed but unexplained methodology
Tech Stack	5%	Fully listed stack, motivated	Most stack components listed and motivated	None to Some stack components listed
Stakeholder Interaction	10%	Great stakeholder interaction, all requirements discussed	Identified most requirements with discussion	None to poor stakeholder interaction and requirement identification
Initial Design & Dev Plan	20%	Comprehensive dev plan, system design, ui design, roadmap	Adequate plan	Incomplete, partial plan
Implementation	20%	All supporting requirements and features implemented	Most supporting requirements and features implemented	None to some supporting requirements and features implemented

3.2 Milestone 2: Sprint 2

Criteria	Weight	Advanced	Intermediate	Basic
Core Features	25%	Implemented with at most one non-severe bugs	Implemented with some non-severe bugs, or one severe bug	Not fully implemented or featuring severe bugs
Automated Testing	10%	UI and API testing implemented - useful and extensive tests	UI or API testing with simple or default tests	No testing
Stakeholder Reviews	10%	Extensive evidence of regular stakeholder interaction, evaluated and integrated stakeholder feedback	Evidence of stakeholder interaction, evaluated stakeholder feedback	No stakeholder feedback, stakeholder feedback ignored without motivation
API	15%	API available externally with documentation and have integrated external API	Mostly implemented API, some external integration	No / minimal external API integration, API not available
User Feedback	10%	Extensive User testing - Formal Feedback collection processes, evidence of collection and integration	Some user testing - formal feedback collection process, evidence of collection, but no integration	No user testing, Non-formal collection
Project Methodology	10%	Actively following methodology	Mostly following methodology	None to poor following of methodology
Bug Tracker	5%	Extensive and continuous use of bug tracker	Use of a bug tracker	No use of a bug tracker
Database Documentation	5%	Full schema documentation, deployment info and motivation	Some db documentation, deployment info	No documentation
Third-Party Code Documentation	5%	All third-party code documented and motivated	Most third party code documented	No to poor documentation of third party code

Criteria	Weight	Advanced	Intermediate	Basic
Testing Documentation	5%	Extensive documentation on testing - user feedback formal process, automated testing procedure, policy around tests	Some testing documentation - user feedback process, automated testing	None to poor documentation

3.3 Milestone 3: Sprint 3

Criteria	Weight	Advanced	Intermediate	Basic
User Feedback	10%			
Automated Testing	10%			
Feature Implementation	20%			
API Implementation	20%			
Performance	5%			
Improvement	5%			
Documentation	15%			
Project Methodology	15%			

3.4 Milestone 4: Project Submission

Criteria	Category	Weight	Advanced	Intermediate	Basic
Data	Database	3%			
Deployment	Database	2%			
Structure	Database	5%			
Availability	API	3%			
Architecture	API	5%			
Deployment	API	2%			
Performance	API	5%			
Design	API	10%			
Accessibility	App	5%			
Aesthetics	App	3%			
User Experience	App	5%			
Deployment	App	2%			
Performance	App	5%			

Criteria	Category	Weight	Advanced	Intermediate	Basic
Features	App	10%			
Responsiveness	App	5%			
Structure	App	5%			
Git Methodology	Misc	5%			
Integration	Misc	7%			
Testing	Misc	8%			
Tools	Misc	5%			

3.5 Report 1: Group Report

3.6 Report 2: Individual Report

3.7 Report 3: Peer Review

3.8 Report 4: Group Presentation